

1.2 Keyboards And Mice

Keyboards and mice are the most-used input devices and the least-upgraded ones. The main reason people don't upgrade these is belief in the 'if it ain't broke, don't fix it' principle. However, if you use your computer for the most part of the day (or night!), you need to think about your fingers and wrists. Carpal Tunnel Syndrome, or CTS as it is commonly known, is a physical issue that occurs with many computer users. One of the most common reasons that it begins is because of repetitive bending of the wrist. Poor ergonomics and irregular posture are other reasons.

At a time when computers cost a bomb, no one paid attention to what kind of keyboard came with them—users went along with whatever was available. And so, if you are still using an old 101-key keyboard, it's time you upgraded to a newer one. Keyboards available today are more ergonomic, provide extensive ease of use, and the best part is, they come cheap.

You can start from a basic multimedia keyboard from Acer or Samsung with multimedia keys and buttons. The buttons on the keyboard act as shortcuts for opening some the most-used applications in Windows such as the Media Player, Internet Explorer, and others. If price is no concern, you can choose a spill-proof RF wireless keyboard with which you can have long, strain-free gaming sessions. Some models from Microsoft retail at around Rs 4,900, and offer a host of features such as optical fingerprint recognition and more.

Keyboards are available from various companies including no-name local brands that are here today, gone tomorrow. We suggest you upgrade to a keyboard from a well-known brand, even if there is some difference in the price. For our views on various keyboards, refer to the handy *Digit* PDF section on our DVD, or check out our buying guide in the December 2004 issue. A few keyboards are shown here as well.